

UX Benchmark and Research

Building an Editor Moodle Platform – Team 74

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1- Design patterns across learning platforms

Moodle is a free open-source Learning Management System (LMS) used by OAPA to run Editor Academy courses to train editors, writers and researchers. It is important that the platform is designed such that it supports heuristic principles and UX best practices as well as support the users in their learning journey. The platforms researched in this report and compared are Canvas and Coursera.

Canvas is a web-based LMS developed by Instructure, it is utilised by schools, universities and organisations to manage courses and classes. The delivery can be online, or hybrid.

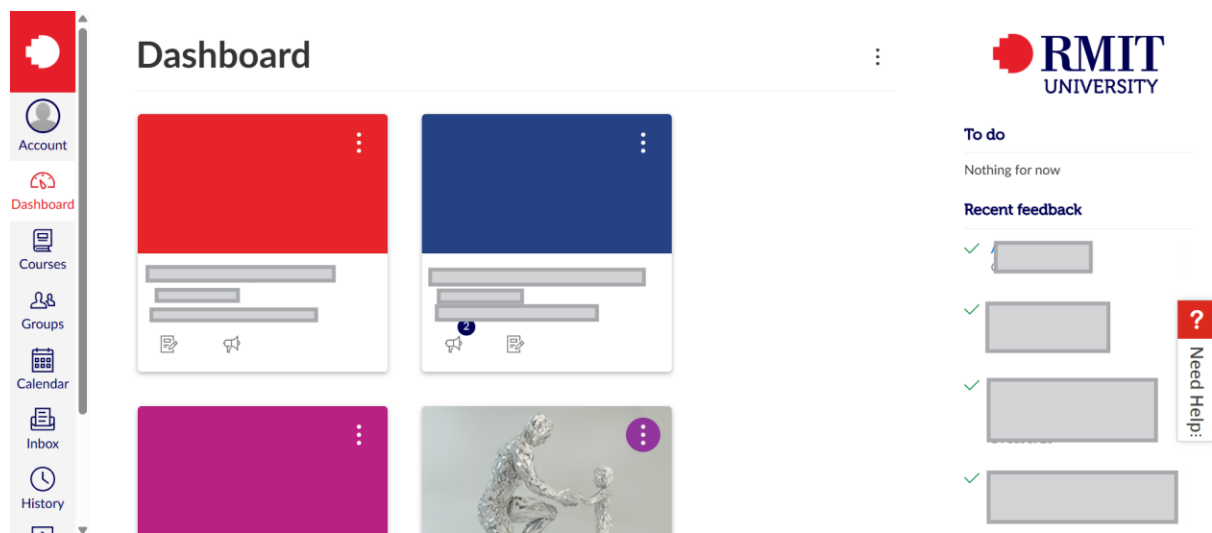


Figure 1: Canvas dashboard page

Canvas has a minimal design. Once logged in it lands the users to the dashboard page by default. This avoids cluttering the user with information right at the start and helps with navigation. The default dashboard page is where the user's enrolled courses are, in cards shown in Figure 1. Each course is labelled in with the course name, the code and the semester it is in. Highlighting visual hierarchy within the text. The navigation menu panel is in the left and slides, with account, dashboard, courses and groups, in addition to various plugins such as the calendar. This supports usability which allows for navigation to run more smoothly between sections.

On the right panels there is a to do list where the information is taken from the assignments and work in the courses and placed there, as well as recent feedback

section with feedback displayed from the courses' the user is currently active in. Allowing the user to monitor their progress and keeps them engaged with the platform. Coursera is an online learning platform that teams up with universities and companies to offer classes and professional certificates.

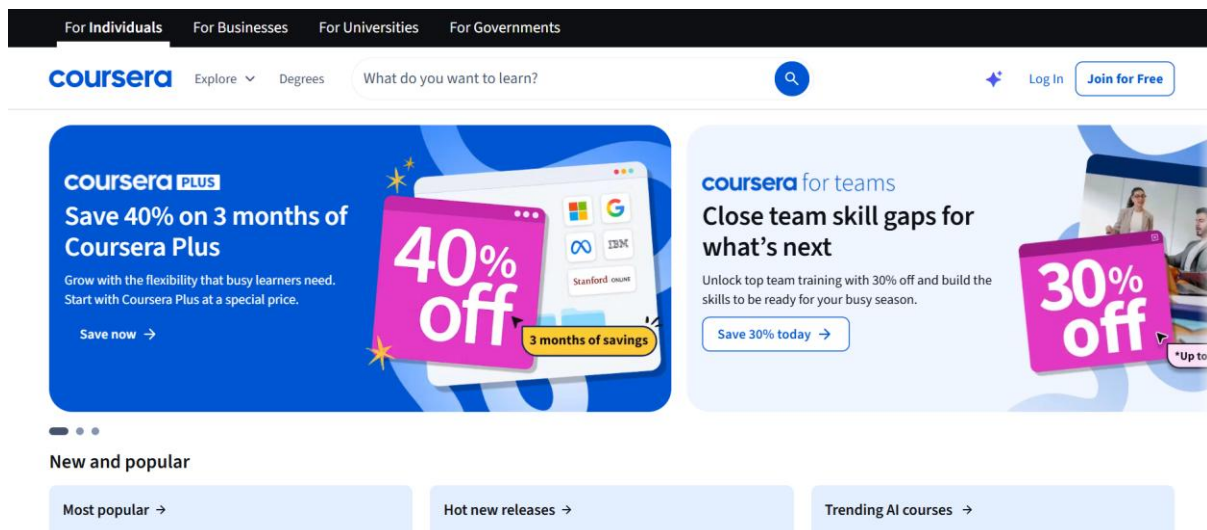


Figure 2: Coursera Landing Page

In comparison to Canvas, Coursera is more general and encompasses a wide range of courses. Therefore, the user is expected to navigate and choose their own from what of interest to them. The landing page consists of advertisements on their paid plus program as shown in Figure 2.

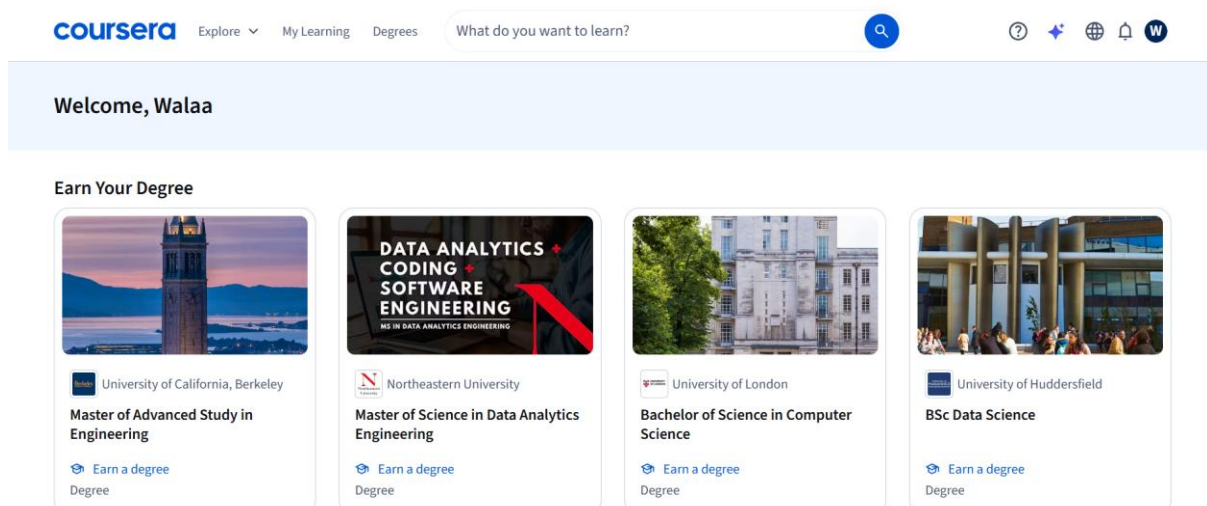


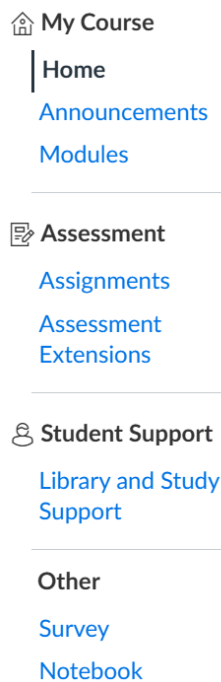
Figure 3: Coursera dashboard

Once logged in the user is shown suggestions in regard to degrees and courses. the degrees suggested are displayed as cards with images that resemble the degree, the

university name that is offering the degree with a light grey text. The name of the degree is clearly displayed. There is a visual text hierarchy, making the overall look of the landing page organised. However, the overall page does have visual clutter to it, with bright colours, images that follow different aesthetics and redundant text.

Platform	Design Patterns	Heuristic supported
Canvas	• Minimal default landing state • Card-based course grouping • Aggregated task list (to-do-panel) • Feedback surfacing panel	• Aesthetic and minimalist design • Recognition rather than recall • User control and freedom • Visibility of system status
Coursera	• Promotion landing pattern • Personalised recommendation card • Card based catalogue browsing • High design pattern	• Flexibility and efficiency of use • Recognition rather than recall

2- Navigation and signposting



Navigation in Canvas is mainly in two layers: the left navigation panel where the user can navigate back to the dashboard, courses or their personal account information, and once clicked on a course they can navigate through a structured additional panel shown in Figure 4. The user lands in the default page 'Home' and can navigate to modules, assignments, etc. This is helpful as it visualises the structure of the course and is efficient. In addition, side panels such as the ones shown in Figure 4 are space efficient. Balancing between space and time efficiency for the users.

Coursera handles navigation through a navigation bar at the top of the page. As shown in Figure 3, the navigation bar contains Explore, My Learning and Degrees. The user knows where they are in the page through the utilisation of breadcrumbs.

Figure 4: Canvas Course panel

Platform	Design Patterns	Heuristic Supported
Canvas	• Persistent collapsible side navigation	• Consistency and standards • Flexibility and efficiency of use
Coursera	• Navigation bar at the top of the page • Self-directed browse navigation • Use of breadcrumbs	• Flexibility and efficiency of use • Visibility of system status

3- Course-content presentation

The course content in canvas is structured under 'Modules' and is customisable by the staff members and teaching team. It is structured in a way whereas more content is added the user can scroll vertically, and this allows for a more compact and efficient way for users to find all the course content at once. Similarly to the specifications for the Moodle platform, the 'Modules' feature in canvas is prepared for asynchronous content. Where students can come back to anytime. The platform allows for a view of completion for content for the user to keep track of their progress and this is a feature the admin is free to use.

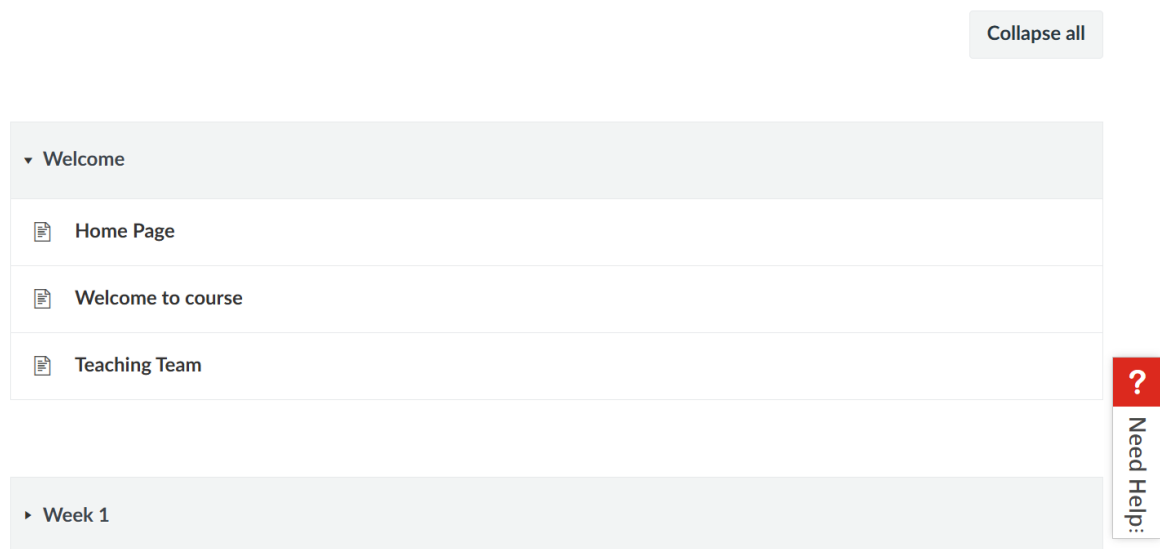


Figure 5: Canvas modules

The content is categorised in different categories such as the academic week shown in Figure 5, while all the content for that category/week is collapsible under the header. The content has an icon next to it showing what form of content it is, usually it's a file that takes the student to another page with the content. Canvas utilises the breadcrumbs feature at the top of the page; this is helpful for navigation.

The content in Coursera is structured in a side sliding panel in the left of the page. The courses' modules are all structured under the course material as shown in Figure 6.

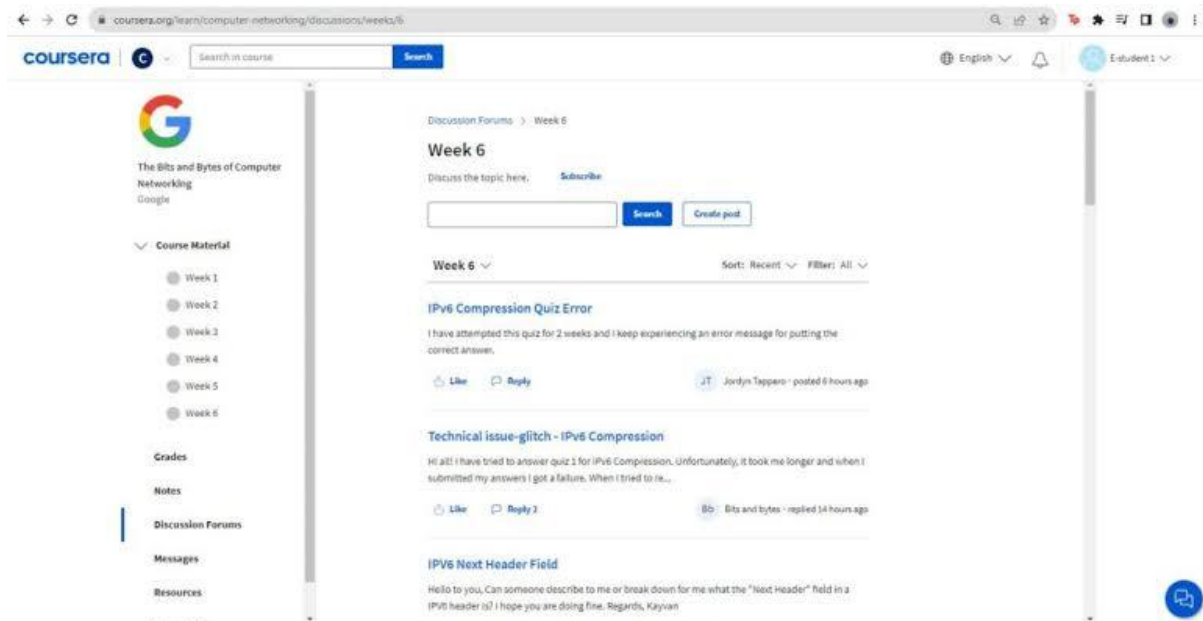


Figure 6: Coursera Course

Coursera places all the content in the centre to the right of the page. Similarly to canvas, it has a vertical scrolling method where the users scroll vertically to view the content in the page. In addition, there are progress signposting that helps the users know the progress of their work.

4- Accessibility and responsive considerations

Coursera includes closed captions and transcripts on video content as well as adjustable playback speed. It also has a mobile app with offline download of lessons. Canvas's accessibility features include built-in accessibility checker for course pages, alt-text prompts for images, and enforced heading structure for screen readers. It also has a responsive web layout as well as apps for IOS and Android.

5- Implications for Editor Academy

- Editor academy should land users on a dashboard immediately after login, not a promotional or browse page, this directly mirrors Canvas's minimal landing state and avoids the visual clutter flagged in Coursera's pre-login page.
- Coursera cards for editor academy should follow canvas's labelling convention.

- A persistent collapsible side panel
- Breadcrumbs should be used
- Content should remain accessible after the system has set them to complete.
- Progress signposting

References:

https://www.google.com/search?sca_esv=2d8f572544f1b32e&sxsrf=APpeQnsmq-0HExwDScowfHn9ee1Cm_07Yw:1787438481499&udm=2&fbs=ABfTbFVyMZGZf1hfvX9uKjN_-G8cxpBkeleqYwoCbfNVc4vKEwpHWb4GllXaHEISn7pMuLEjl4dPJAKb532KxkRztNQkLdis50NWciW_nUCwt4lOcUiGaKW0DoiFV4x0yBmBJ6LWBfvnhqRT1_Y3gomSSRshudwzDejBnUDAAa8zIKn3VP_9aC2XvlievYY8vbj17-7v7OSElozYX58ZZXGVo2G0dsa6IA&q=coursera+courses&sa=X&sqi=2&ved=2ahUKEwjEp_2dp7WWAxXyT2wGHaqNNJMQtKgLegQIHxAB&biw=1280&bih=551&dpr=1.5#sv=CA MSXhoyKhBLUVXVndTYjBXbjhCQy1NMg5FV1Z3U2lwV244QkMtTToOdVNveHp3VjllMjJUOU0gBCokCg42V2x2bks5bWh1S3VjTRIQZS1FV1Z3U2lwV244QkMtTRgAMAEYByChudv vB0oIEAEYASABKAE